

ROMAN LEGIONARY'S ARMOUR AND WEAPONS

The Roman legionary, the mainstay of the Roman army, fought in legions roughly 5,000 strong. Their equipment was well adapted for fighting in close formation, each soldier being equipped with two *pila* (javelins) that could be hurled, and a *gladius* (short stabbing sword), which was used in hand-to-hand fighting. The dimensions of the equipment changed over time – a longer slashing sword, the *spatha*, came to be preferred over the *gladius*.



Overlapping scales

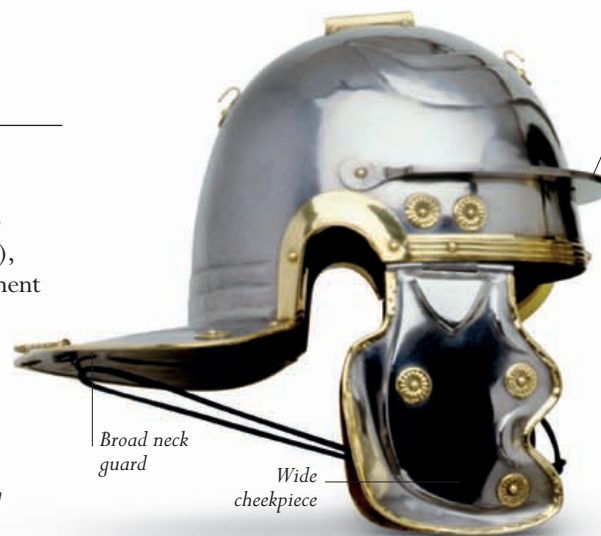
▲ LORICA SQAMATA

Date 1st century CE

Origin Roman Empire

Material Iron

Legionaries often wore armour of overlapping metal scales a few centimetres long, made of copper or iron, bound together with iron and sewn onto a cloth underpiece. By the late 1st century CE, it was increasingly superseded by *lorica segmentata*.



Brow guard

◀ GALLIC HELMET

Date Late 1st century CE

Origin Roman Empire

Material Iron

This modern replica depicts an Imperial-Gallic helmet that was influenced by Celtic models and had a deeper neck guard than earlier Roman helmets, which made it harder to crouch and dictated a more upright fighting style for its wearers.

Broad neck guard

Wide cheekpiece



Shoulder protection

Bronze and leather attachments to hold metal plates together

Central boss deflected spear and sword thrusts

◀ SCUTUM

Date 1st century CE

Origin Roman Empire

Weight 6.8–9kg (15–20lb)

Width 73cm (29in)

The *scutum* (legionary shield) was a long rectangle that curved inwards to form a part cylinder, giving greater protection to its wearer. As depicted on this modern replica, it was adorned with legionary insignia. When not in use, it was protected by a leather cover.

▲ LORICA SEGMENTATA

Date Late 1st century CE

Origin Roman Empire

Material Iron, bronze, leather

This modern replica Roman armour is made up of overlapping iron plates with leather straps running underneath. It probably had its origins in gladiatorial equipment and, although providing good protection, the complicated fittings made it hard to maintain.

Long, tapered point

Triangular tip

